ASSORTMENT STRATEGY · PORTFOLIO PROJECT

Editing Sephora's *Body Care* Assortment

Fewer redundant SKUs, sharper growth bets, and a clearer reason to shop body care at Sephora.



Sarah Lahlali · October 2026

Independent project; not affiliated with Sephora.

01 · THE BRIEF

Our *scope* and objective

Scope

Body care across U.S. stores and online: moisturizers, wash, mists, treatments, deodorant, hand care and self-tan. Hair, makeup, facial skincare and fine fragrance are out of scope.



Objective

Recommend which brands and SKUs to keep, cut and add so every product earns its space and the category grows.



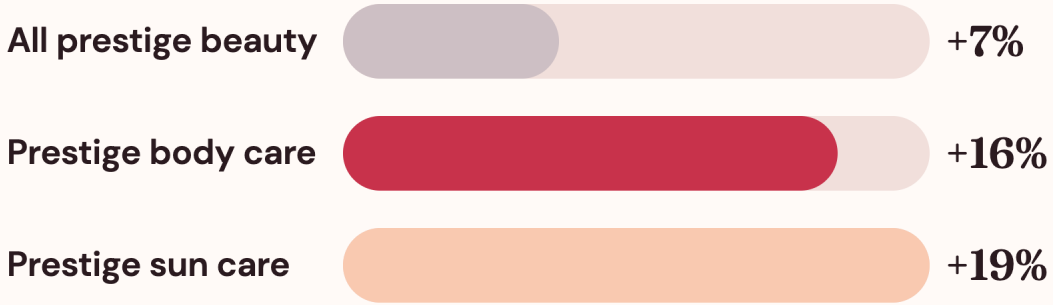
Constraints

Total shelf space stays flat. The edit must protect Beauty Insider favorites and keep good, better and best price coverage.

02 · WHY NOW

Body care is *outpacing* prestige beauty

U.S. SALES GROWTH, FIRST HALF OF 2026



Prestige body care grew more than 2× as fast as prestige beauty overall.

ACTIVES **go body-wide**

Salicylic acid and peptides now appear in deodorants, body washes and hand lotions.

SCENT **= affordable luxury**

Fragrance was a top category in H1 2026; mists bridge scent and body care.

VALUE **drives choices**

Mass outgrew prestige in Q1 2026, and mini sizes surged in 2025.

Sources: Circana U.S. beauty reports (Q1 2026, H1 2026, Oct 2025); BeautyMatter, Sept 2026.

03 · THE SHOPPER

Three shoppers *define* the category



The Scent-Led Shopper

Discovers through scent. Buys mists, creams and matching sets, often as gifts or add-ons.

Bum Bum Cream: 10K+ reviews



The Results Seeker

Wants visible change for texture, bumps, dryness or uneven tone. Reads ingredient lists.

INKEY body stick: 870+ reviews



The Everyday Upgrader

Trades up on daily basics like body wash, deodorant and hand care, and replenishes often.

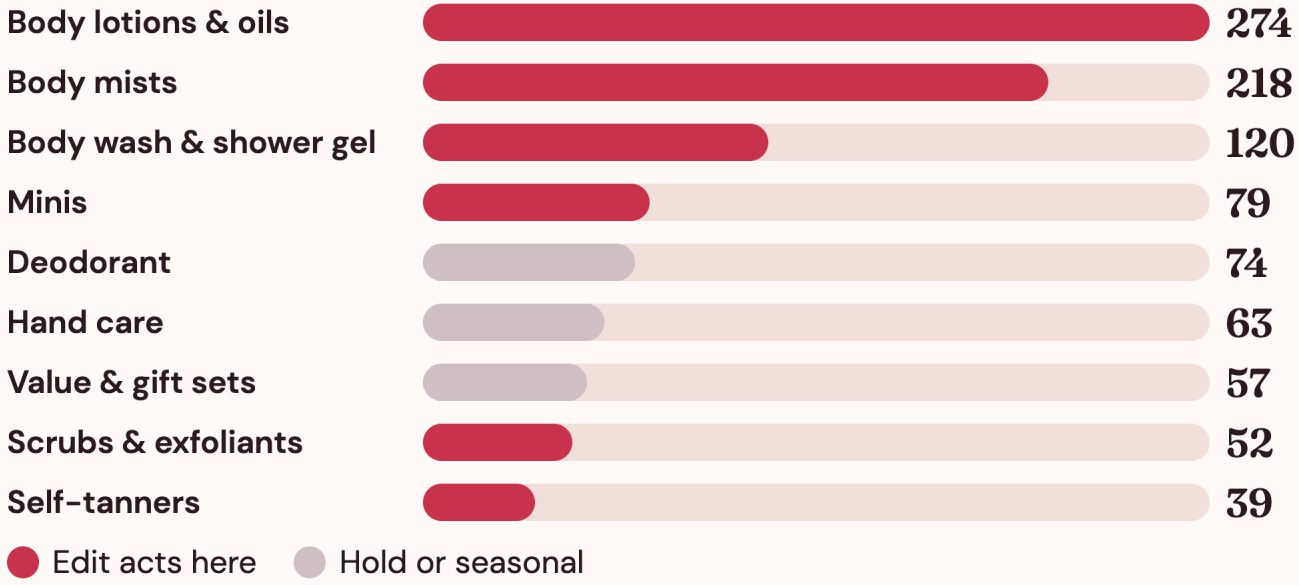
Touchland mist: 2.9K reviews

Review counts from Sephora.com, October 7, 2026.

04 · CURRENT ASSORTMENT

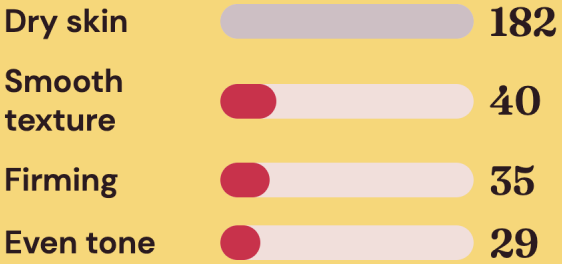
Lots of lotion, *few treatments*

PRODUCTS ON SEPHORA.COM BY SUBCATEGORY



The treatment gap

Products by body concern



6× as many dry-skin products as even-tone products

Sephora.com (U.S.), October 7, 2026. Categories overlap; body mists sit under Fragrance online and exclude 10 mist sets.

05 · COMPETITION

Competitors are moving into *prestige body care*

BATH & BODY WORKS

Scent authority

Sales down 2.3% in Q2 2026; now in about 600 Ulta stores.

Sephora's move → prestige scent and efficacy

ULTA BEAUTY

Breadth

Pairs Bath & Body Works with its own mass and prestige ranges.

Sephora's move → curation and exclusives

AMAZON

Replenishment

Bath & Body Works' Amazon sales more than tripled, Q1 to Q2.

Sephora's move → Beauty Insider + Auto-Replenish

TIKTOK SHOP

Speed

Beauty is its top category in 2026.

Sephora's move → faster test-and-learn

Sources: Bath & Body Works Q2 2026 results and 10-Q; Zacks via CNHI News; Circana, May 2026.

06 · THE EDIT

Every SKU gets a *role* and a *test*

Keep

- Top 20% by review count in its subcategory
- Rated 4.3 stars or higher
- Hero, exclusive or unique price point

Cut

- Under 50 reviews after 12+ months
- Rated below 4.0 stars
- Same claim, price and format as a stronger SKU

Add

- Fills a gap in skin concern or price tier
- Proven momentum in other channels
- Brings new demand, not just shifted sales

Review counts and ratings stand in for sales data, which Sephora does not publish.

07 · WHAT WE CUT

Trim 70 *look-alike* SKUs

−40

40 of 274 lotions and oils (15%)

Undifferentiated lotions

Of 274 lotions and oils, trim SKUs with no clear scent, efficacy or price-tier role.

−20

20 of 120 washes (17%)

Look-alike body washes

Of 120 washes, keep each brand's top scents and cut repeat variants.

−10

10 of 39 self-tanners (26%)

Off-season self-tan

Move slower self-tanners to online-only outside spring and summer.

✨ **Freed space:** 70 SKUs of shelf space, reinvested in 65 new SKUs.

08 · WHERE WE GROW

Four *growth bets*

★ PRIMARY GROWTH BET

+35

🧪 Body treatments

Tone, texture and firming products plus exfoliants, where the range is thinnest. More than half of all new SKUs go here.

Brand watch: Dealbodies (Accelerate 2026)

🌸 Scent layering — +15

Grow the 218 mists and add matching creams, shown by scent.

Brand watch: Obart (630 doors), Reference

🧼 Active basics — Swap

Replace look-alike washes with salicylic acid and peptide formulas.

Uses space freed by the wash cuts

👜 Minis & entry prices — +15

Travel sizes and discovery kits near checkout.

Sephora Collection body wash from $13

09 · ON THE SHELF

Brands already *showing the way*

SCENT LAYERING



Summer Fridays · matching butters + mists



CYKLAR · wash + in-shower balm per scent

VALUE & ENTRY PRICES



Sephora Collection · washes from $13



Josie Maran · jar + refill pouch

ROUTINES & RESULTS



Nécessaire · full-body routine



amika · body serum for uneven tone

All brands shown are sold at Sephora.com. Product images: brand photography, for illustration only.

10 · THE RESULT

The edited assortment *at a glance*

Body lotions & oils	274 → 234	−40	Trim
Body wash & shower gel	120 → 100	−20	Consolidate
Self-tanners (in stores)	39 → 29	−10	Online-only
Treatment-led body care*	new depth	+35	Expand
Body mists & layering	218 → 233	+15	Expand
Minis	79 → 94	+15	Expand
Value & gift sets	57 → 57	0	Seasonal
Deodorant & hand care	137 → 137	0	Hold



Net change: −5 SKUs · cut 70, add 65 · space-neutral

*Concern categories overlap on Sephora.com, so this row shows direction, not a unique SKU count.

11 · IMPACT

What the edit is *designed to improve*

SHELF SPACE FREED · 70 SKUS

- Lotions & oils −40
- Body washes −20
- Self-tan −10

SHELF SPACE REINVESTED · 65 SKUS

- 🧪 Treatments +35
- 🌸 Mists +15
- 👜 Minis +15
- −5

Space-neutral: net −5 SKUs, no new fixtures

Goal: higher sales per SKU and per linear foot

EXPECTED OUTCOMES

- 👜 Easier entry prices
- 🌸 More mist + cream attachment
- 🧹 Cleaner shelf
- 🧪 Stronger treatment penetration

12 · ROLLOUT

Pilot first, then scale

1 Pilot

MONTHS 1–3

Pilot the edited assortment in 20 representative stores and Sephora.com, benchmarked against 20 comparable control stores.

2 Read and adjust

MONTHS 4–6

Compare to control stores. Drop weak additions and add depth behind early winners.

3 Scale

MONTHS 7–12

Roll out winners nationally: new planograms, mists shown with body care online, and associate training.

HOW WE MEASURE SUCCESS

Sales per SKU **Sales per linear foot** **Sell-through** **Basket attachment** **Repeat purchase**

OUR RECOMMENDATION

Fewer look-alikes, *more reasons to shop.*

Cut 70 look-alike SKUs and reinvest in treatment-led body care, scent layering, active basics and minis, then pilot before scaling.

Sarah Lahlali

Methodology: counts, ratings and reviews captured from Sephora.com on October 7, 2026. Categories may overlap; reviews and ratings are directional proxies because sales data is not public.

